

TECHNICAL ASSESSMENT

Concerning the Inaccessible Sewer Inspection Chamber

Date: 23 June 2026

Client

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1. Purpose

This technical expert assessment has been prepared following a site inspection carried out in connection with the planning of construction works at the above property.

The purpose of this report is to document the observed conditions regarding the property's sewer inspection chamber and the inability to locate the inspection chamber cover during the inspection.

This report represents a professional construction assessment only and does not express any legal opinion regarding liability.

2. Site Inspection

During the inspection, the property's drainage system was reviewed using the available drainage drawings.

Based on these drawings, an attempt was made to locate the existing sewer inspection chamber.

Despite comparing the drawings with the existing site conditions, it was not possible to locate the inspection chamber cover.

No destructive investigations or excavation works were carried out during the inspection.

3. Observations

The following observations were made:

- The available drainage drawings indicate the expected location of the sewer inspection chamber.
- No visible inspection chamber cover could be located at or near the indicated position.
- The area has since been covered with paving slabs.
- Based on the observed conditions, it appears likely that the inspection chamber cover may have been covered during subsequent paving works.

As no excavation or removal of paving was carried out, this assessment is based solely on visual observations and the available documentation.

4. Professional Construction Assessment

In my professional opinion, access to a sewer inspection chamber should remain permanently available for:

- inspection,
- maintenance,
- cleaning,
- CCTV inspection,
- repairs,
- emergency access.

Where the inspection chamber cover cannot be located, these operations become difficult or impossible without first removing the surface covering.

Should the chamber cover have been covered by paving slabs, excavation and reinstatement of the paved area will be required in order to restore proper access.

5. Practical Consequences

The inability to access the sewer inspection chamber may result in:

- additional costs for future maintenance,
 - increased costs for CCTV inspections,
 - increased costs for drainage repairs,
 - additional excavation and reinstatement works,
 - delays during emergency drainage works.
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6. Recommendation

It is recommended that the exact location of the sewer inspection chamber be established by an authorised drainage contractor using appropriate locating equipment.

Should it be confirmed that the chamber cover has been covered by paving or other permanent surfacing, the chamber should be exposed and provided with permanent, visible access in accordance with good construction practice.

7. Conclusion

During the site inspection it was not possible to locate the property's sewer inspection chamber, despite its indicated position on the available drainage drawings.

Based on the available documentation and the observed site conditions, it appears likely that the chamber cover may have been covered during previous paving works.

No destructive investigations were carried out, and this conclusion is therefore based solely on the available documentation and the visual observations made during the inspection.

This report represents a professional construction assessment only.

Appendices

Appendix 1 – Drainage Drawings

Appendix 2 – Site Photographs

Prepared on 23 June 2026

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